OLC Accelerate
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AZUSA PACIFIC UNIVERSITY

Detection to documentation:

Using a ‘Revision History’ extension to support authentic student writing in the age of AI

Discovery Session | Wed, Nov 18, 2026 | 1:00–1:45 PM ET | Atlantic B, Position 6



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Detection alone falls short

1 in 4

students use AI to write papers or essays

EDUCAUSE, 2026

50%

of students worry AI erodes their critical thinking

EDUCAUSE, 2026

61%

of essays by non-native English writers flagged as AI by detectors

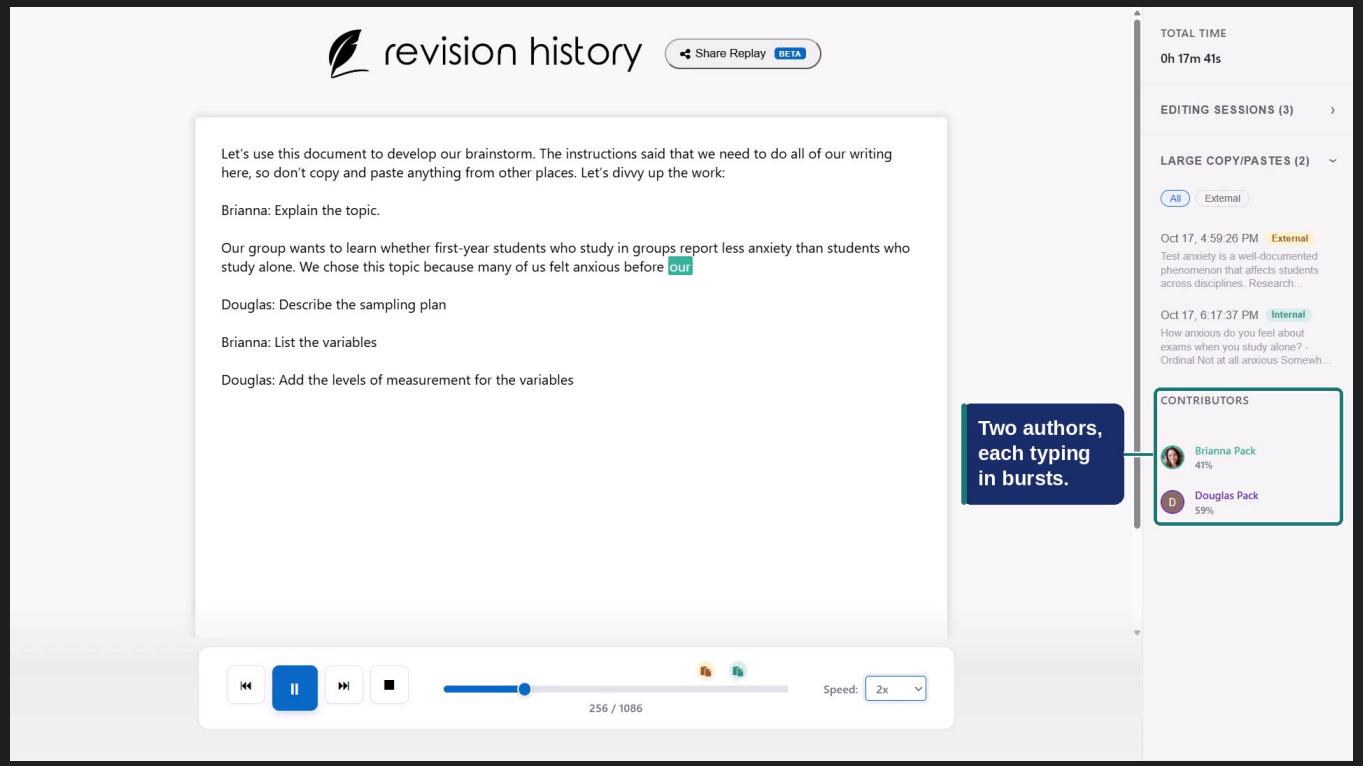
Liang et al., 2023

Detection guesses from the product. Documentation shows the process.

Neurodivergent students may face more false flags too (Eaton, 2025). Liang: average across 7 detectors.
EDUCAUSE: 8,622 students.

The tool: Revision History

A free Chrome extension that reads the edit history Google Docs already keeps. We are not affiliated with it.



WHAT IT IS

A free, third-party extension for Google Docs and Slides

WHAT IT SHOWS

Writing time, every paste, who wrote what, and a replay

WHAT IT ISN'T

An AI detector. It makes no judgment.

It shows the process. You make the call.

Make your students SHOW their work

The SHOW approach: [tagline placeholder: from detection to documentation, the process over the product]

S **Structure the assignment**
Set up milestones in one shared Doc, so you can see the writing process.

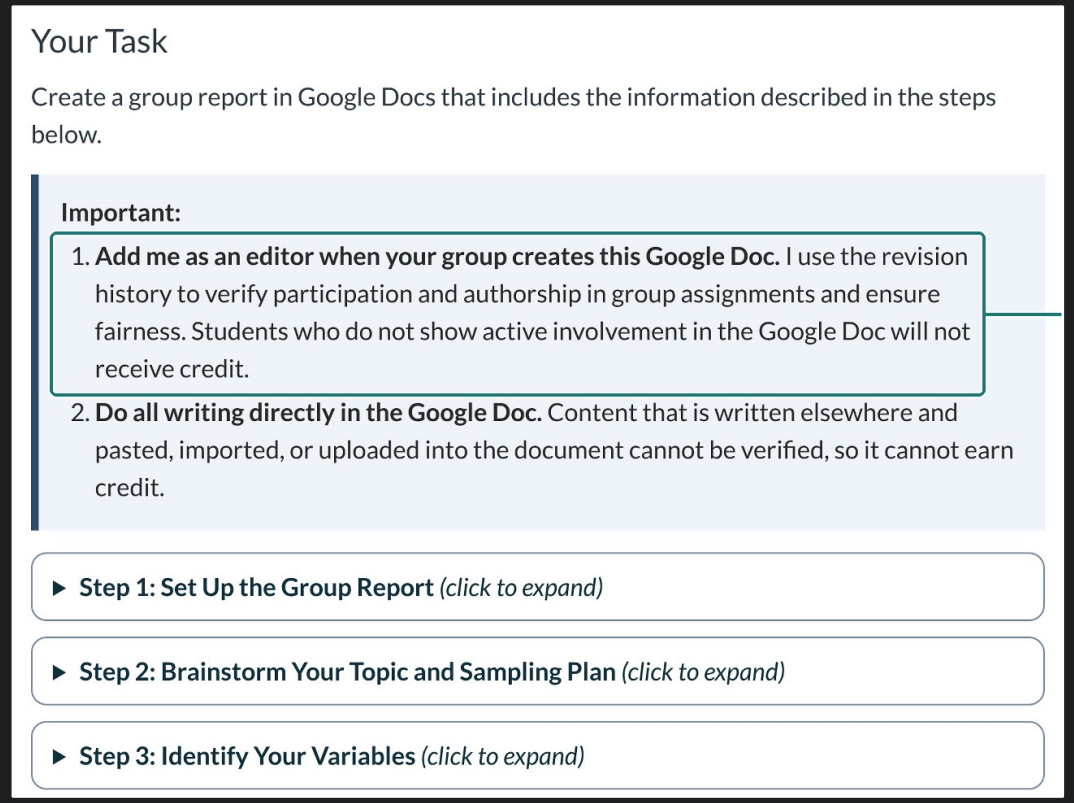
H **Hold students accountable**
Enforce the requirements, like no pasting, so the process stays visible.

O **Observe and respond**
Give feedback on the process at each milestone, so students improve.

W **Weigh the whole picture**
Grade the whole process, not just the final product.

Example 1: A group project

A group report built milestone by milestone in one shared Google Doc.



Your Task

Create a group report in Google Docs that includes the information described in the steps below.

Important:

1. **Add me as an editor when your group creates this Google Doc.** I use the revision history to verify participation and authorship in group assignments and ensure fairness. Students who do not show active involvement in the Google Doc will not receive credit.
2. **Do all writing directly in the Google Doc.** Content that is written elsewhere and pasted, imported, or uploaded into the document cannot be verified, so it cannot earn credit.

▶ **Step 1: Set Up the Group Report** *(click to expand)*

▶ **Step 2: Brainstorm Your Topic and Sampling Plan** *(click to expand)*

▶ **Step 3: Identify Your Variables** *(click to expand)*

HOW THIS ASSIGNMENT USES SHOW

- **S** — **One report, built in steps**
- **H** — **No pasting; everyone contributes**
- **O** — **Feedback, then revision**
- **W** — **Credit for each member's part**

Example 2: Writing over time

[Sharon's course]: a paper written in stages, in one Google Doc.

[Sharon's assignment instructions: a cropped image goes here]

HOW THIS ASSIGNMENT USES SHOW

- **S** One paper, drafted in stages
- **H** All drafting in the Doc
- **O** Comments, then revision
- **W** Growth across drafts counts

Your turn

Try it now: add revisionhistory.com to Chrome, then open a Doc you wrote.

Try it, step by step

On your own Google Doc, plus SHOW and the handout.

Scan, then tap *Start with Step 1*

Install: revisionhistory.com

Your feedback matters!

Scan, then choose Evaluate Session.

Each evaluation is an entry to win a $25 gift card.

Best-In-Track